

Detecting emotions and emotional technology

- Sensing technologies used to measure GSR, facial expressions, gestures, body movement
- Aim is to predict user's emotions and aspects of their behavior –
- E.g. what is someone most likely to buy online when feeling sad, bored or happy

Facial Coding

- Measures a user's emotions as they interact with a computer or tablet
- Analyses images captured by a webcam of their face
- Uses this to gauge how engaged the user is when looking at movies, online shopping sites and ads
- 6 core expressions - sadness, happiness, disgust, fear, surprise and anger

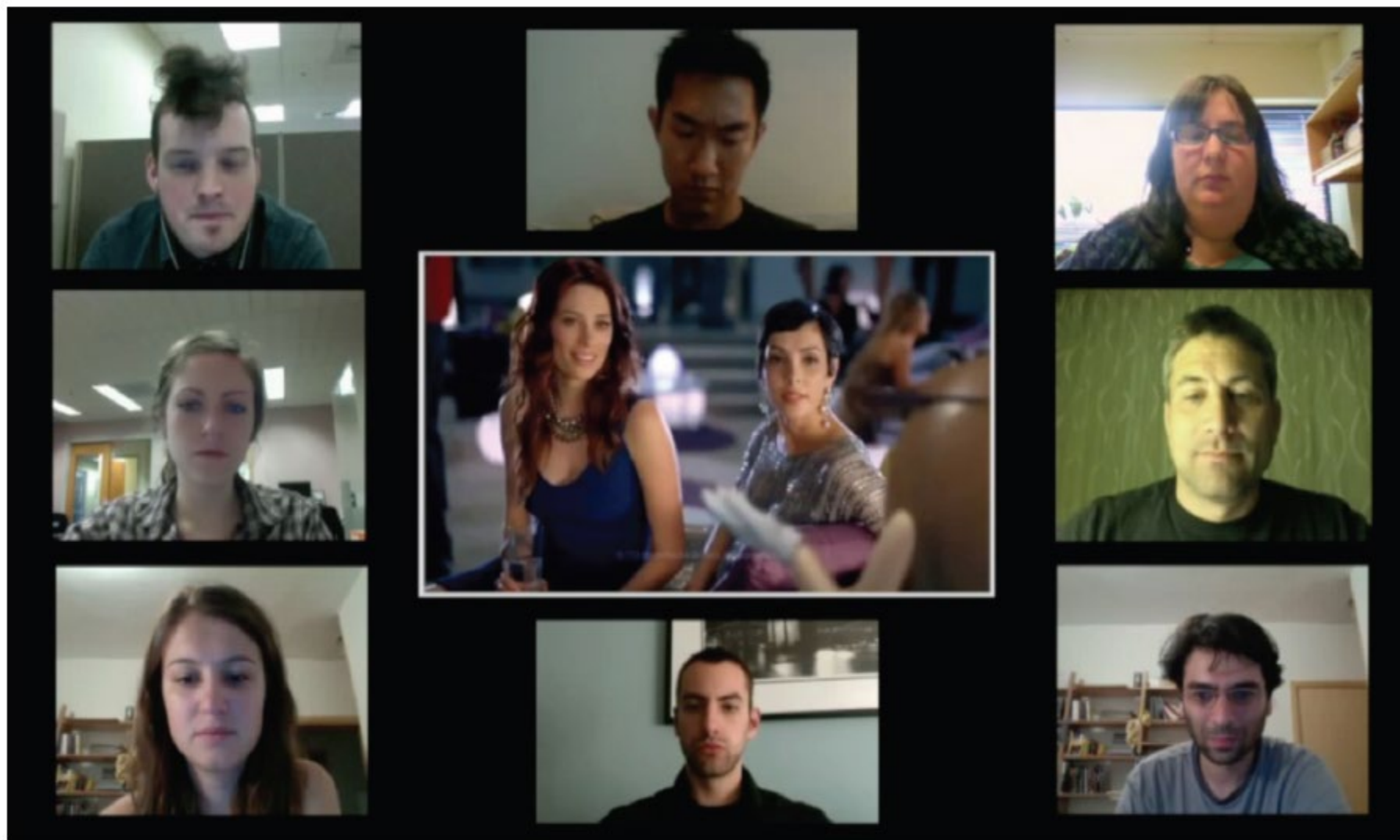


Figure 5.9 A screen shot showing facial coding from Affdex software

Source: Courtesy of Affectiva, Inc.

How to use the emotional data?

- If user screws up their face when an ad pops up -> feel disgust
- If start smiling -> they are feeling happy
- Website can adapt its ad, movie storyline or content to match user's emotional state
- Eye-tracking, finger pulse, speech and words/phrases also analysed when tweeting or posting to Facebook

Indirect emotion detection

- Beginning to be used more to infer or predict someone's behavior
- For example, determining a person's suitability for a job, or how they will vote at an election
- Do you think it is creepy that technology can read your emotions from your facial expressions or from your tweets?